

TANG ZICHEN

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Education

The Hong Kong University of Science and Technology <i>PhD Student, Supervisor: Prof. Bo LI</i>	Sep 2025 – Present
The Hong Kong University of Science and Technology (Guangzhou) <i>MPhil in Data Science and Analytics, Supervisors: Prof. Xiaowen CHU, Prof. Sihong XIE</i>	Sep 2023 – Jul 2025
The Hong Kong University of Science and Technology <i>BEng in Computer Science and Mathematics (Double Major)</i>	Sep 2019 – Jun 2023

Publications

* Equal contribution. † Corresponding author.

Distributed / Federated ML Systems

- Z. Tang*, J. Huang*, **Z. Tang***, X. Kang, Y. Wang, P. Dong, S. Shi, X. Chu, B. Li. Capturing and Mitigating Gradient Aggregation Errors for Fault-Tolerant Distributed Training. (**ICML'26**).
- Z. Tang*, **Z. Tang***, J. Huang, X. Pan, R. Yan, Y. Wang, A. Zhou, S. Shi, X. Chu, B. Li. DreamDDP: Accelerating Data Parallel Distributed LLM Training with Layer-wise Scheduled Partial Synchronization. (**MLSys'26**).
- **Z. Tang**, J. Huang, R. Yan, Y. Wang, Z. Tang, S. Shi, A. Zhou, X. Chu. Bandwidth-Aware and Overlap-Weighted Compression for Communication-Efficient Federated Learning. (**ICPP'24**).

Trustworthy LLM & Safety

- **Z. Tang***, Z. Tang*, G. Pan, B. Liu, X. He, K. Lai, X. Chu, B. Li. Ghost in the Cloud: Your Geo-Distributed Large Language Models Training is Easily Manipulated. (**ICLR'26**).
- **Z. Tang***, Z. Tang*†, Q. Wang, G. Pan, Y. Yang, W. He, S. Shi, X. Chu, B. Li†. BiasTrojan: LLM Judges Are Easily Distorted by Few Hundreds of Contrastive Biased Training Data. (**NeurIPS'26**).
- **Z. Tang***, Z. Zhang*, Q. Wang, Z. Tang†, X. Chu, B. Li†. Is Your LLM-as-a-Recommender Agent Trustable? LLMs' Recommendation is Easily Hacked by Biases (Preferences). (**NeurIPS'26 E&D Track**).

Data-centric LLM Training

- **Z. Tang**, Z. Tang, Y. Hou, H. Xing, X. Qi, X. Chu, B. Li. Anchoring the Bridge Across Hops: Unlocking Latent Multi-Hop Reasoning under Knowledge Injection. (**CL4FMAgents @ NeurIPS'26**).
- **Z. Tang**, Z. Tang, Y. Hou, P. Dong, X. Liu, S. Shi, X. Chu, B. Li. Enhancing Knowledge Injection with Surrounding Backgrounds in Continual Training LLMs. (**ICML'26 Workshop**).

Research Interest

Federated/Distributed ML Systems Data-centric LLM LLM Agent

Projects

Agent Inference Task Decomposition and Cost Modeling • Decomposing multi-round Agent tasks into a DAG of LLM-inference and tool-call sub-nodes to enable fine-grained global scheduling. • Building a precise per-node inference cost model for Qwen3-8B (prefill / decode / memory / communication) coupled with a DeBERTa-v3 output-length predictor.	Nov 2025 – Present
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Teaching

COMP 3511 – Operating Systems, Teaching Assistant <i>The Hong Kong University of Science and Technology</i>	Spring 2026; Fall 2027
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Service

ICML 2026, Gold Reviewer <i>Recognized for high-quality reviewing.</i>	2026
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Skills

Professional Skills: Python, PyTorch, PyTorch Distributed, Horovod, DeepSpeed, FSDP, TRL, SGLang, Verl
Language Proficiency: English (TOEFL 105), Chinese (Native), Cantonese (Elementary)
Examination Performance: GRE 324 (Verbal 154, Quant 170, Writing 3.5)